

The dark side of gadget addiction

In his new drama series, *Black Mirror*, Charlie Brooker explores the dark side of our love affair with technology
<http://bit.ly/tCM0bt>

A rose by any other name...

Apple may have to sell its product under a new name in China or part with \$1.6 billion
<http://bit.ly/vaQY5i>

Samsung Galaxy Note

Is it a phone? Or is it a tablet? Feel free...

In a world that is still grappling with the idea of how the smartphone and the tablets will co-exist, Samsung has decided to introduce a completely new category - the hybrid. So where does the Samsung Galaxy Note fit in?

Till now we had considered the 4.0-inch display smartphones as big, but this one with the 5.3-inch display just puts them in the shade. Quite literally! Despite the bigger footprint, it doesn't weigh too much, and manages to remain quite slim as well. The build quality is very good. There aren't any rough edges to the product. The very fact that you can type an SMS with the same hand that is holding the phone is a huge achievement in itself.



The crowning glory is the 5.3-inch Super AMOLED display. The first thing we noticed when comparing it to the Samsung Galaxy SII is that the colour richness has been toned down. Good thing, since the red colour isn't overbearing anymore. The black levels are excellent, and don't look grey anymore. The sharpness levels helps a lot making the text clear. The viewing angles of this display aren't great - let

down by the reflective nature. Any and all ambient objects will be reflecting off the display, if you look at it from a side angle.

The video viewing experience is an absolute delight.

While watching a video or listening to music, you will get the 5.1 channel setting activated only if you are using headphones or connected the phone to external speakers. The built-in speaker isn't loud at all. In fact, it is barely enough for a small-ish room. Take it outside for a call or to listen to music, and it is barely audible. Read detailed review online: bit.ly/trErnx

Visbal Mathur

Specifications

Android 2.3.5; ARM Cortex A9 Dual Core 1.4GHz processor; 1GB RAM; 5.3-inch Super AMOLED display; 1280 x 800 pixel resolution; 16GB internal storage; microSD slot (up to 32GB); 8MP camera with 1080p HD videos; 2500 mAh battery

Contact

Samsung India

Phone: (Prefix Local STD Code) 3030 8282

Email: N.A.

Price: ₹34,990

8.0/10

Features	8.0
Performance.....	9.0
Build Quality	7.5
Value for Money	7.5

ASUS X79 Rampage IV Extreme

ROG series on steroids with OC Key and SubZero Sense

Specifications

Form Factor: Extended ATX;

Chipset: Intel X79; **DIMM slots:**

8; **Back Panel Ports:** 4xUSB

3.0, 7xUSB 2.0, 2xeSATA, 1xLAN port; **Expansion slots:** 5xPCIe

3.0, 1xPCIe 2.0;

SATA 6 Gbps ports: 4

Contact

ASUS Technology Pvt. Ltd.

Phone: 1800 209 0365

Email: reachus@asus.com

Website: www.asus.in

Price: ₹28,650

Republic of Gamers series is associated with serious gaming. With the launch of Intel Sandy Bridge E series of processors, motherboards housing the X79 chipset have started to flood the market. Rampage IV Extreme (R4E) is the flagship board from ASUS and its packed with features.

This board comes with PCIe 3.0 certification which means that it will run PCIe 3.0 based devices which are expected to have twice the bandwidth of existing PCIe 2.0 devices. With the ASUS Subzero Sense, you can get the temperature on your CPU as well as GPU with the help of the

Subzero Sense connector. The UEFI BIOS has implemented a shortcut key ie. F3. On any screen in the UEFI BIOS, you can press F3 to access the list of most commonly used tweaking options.

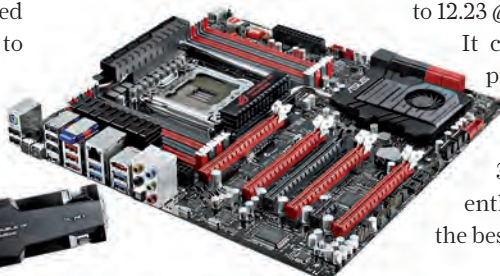
OC Key - which is a piece of hardware that goes into your graphics card display port while you can connect your DVI cable on its outer edge. A wire goes from the OC Key to the moth-

erboard and on pressing the ROG button, you get a graphical overlay on the monitor, which allows you to monitor and adjust CPU and GPU voltages - in real time!

The easy overclocking utility within the ASUS Suite II allows you to speed up the Core i7-3960X to 4.125 GHz and 4.25 GHz. We tried both settings and it works quite well. Cinebench R11.5 went from 11.35 @3.3 GHz to 12.23 @ 4.25 GHz.

It comes at a premium price of Rs. 28,650 and it also bundles in the game Battlefield 3. If you are a gaming enthusiast, this board is the best X79 board.

Nimish Sawant



8.0/10

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Performance.....	8.0
Build Quality	8.0
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